NATIONAL AVIATION OLYMPIAD

National Aviation Olympiad 2026

Olympiad Syllabus

www.nationalaviationolympiad.com

Centre for Scientific Outreach
B1, Third Floor, Greater Kailash Enclave II, New Delhi - 110 048, India.

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NATIONAL AVIATION OLYMPIAD

National Aviation Olympiad

Igniting young minds, elevating India's skies

1st Pan India Aviation Olympiad

Classes 8th - 12th

August 2026 - December 2026

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1. OLYMPIAD STRUCTURE

1.1 Expert Committee

The Olympiad shall be spearheaded by an expert committee comprising the ***Top 100+ aviation professionals*** from the aviation sectors who have contributed to academia, business, and bureaucracy. This expert committee shall be responsible for framing the question papers, evaluating them, and conducting the final examination at the national level

Category	Members	Profiles to Include
Academia	40% members	Professors from IITs/NITs/IISc, aviation universities, CBSE/ICSE experts, STEM/aviation historians, School teachers (Grade 8-12th)
Industry	30% members	Airline pilots & trainers, AMEs, MRO executives, OEM reps (Airbus, Boeing, HAL, DRDO, ISRO), Drone/UAV innovators
Policy & Regulators	30% members	DGCA/BCAS/AAI/MoCA officials, Retired IAF officers, Skill/education policymakers (NSDC, NITI Aayog, AASSC)

1.1.1 Leadership Structure

- Chairperson
- 3 Vice Chairs (Academia, Industry, Policy)
- General Secretary (Academic Convenor)
- Secretariat team (5-7 members)

1.1.2 Roles and Responsibilities

- Making of syllabus, sample papers, and question papers
- Conduction of examination across all three phases
- Conduction of webinars on weekly basis for student preparation
- Internship support for students

1.2 Coordinators

1. **School-level coordinator**: Responsible for conduction of the exam for an individual school. *All school coordinators will receive regular training on the software to be used for the examination and other IT support.*
2. **Zonal-Level coordinator**: Responsible for conduction of the exam for a particular zone.
3. **National-Level coordinator**: Responsible for conduction of the exam at the national and final round.

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1.3 Geographical Division

The conduction of the examination is divided into 5 zones: **North**, **East**, **West**, **South**, and **UT Zone**. It is imperative that there is participation of **ALL** states/Union Territories of India in this Olympiad. There will be separate dates of examinations in all these different zones barring the final examination at the National Level.

Zone	States / UTs Included
North Zone (5 states)	Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh
East Zone (12 states)	Bihar, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha, Sikkim, Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Meghalaya
West Zone (6 states)	Rajasthan, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh
South Zone (5 states)	Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala
UT Zone (8 UTs)	Ladakh, Jammu & Kashmir, Delhi, Chandigarh, Andaman & Nicobar Islands, Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, Puducherry, Lakshadweep

1.4 Target Cities Pan India

State / UT	Top 10 Cities
Andhra Pradesh	Visakhapatnam, Vijayawada, Guntur, Nellore, Kurnool, Rajahmundry, Tirupati, Anantapur, Chittoor, Srikakulam
Arunachal Pradesh	Itanagar, Naharlagun, Pasighat, Ziro, Tawang, Bomdila, Tezu, Roing, Namsai, Aalo
Assam	Guwahati, Dibrugarh, Jorhat, Silchar, Nagaon, Tinsukia, Tezpur, Barpeta, Bongaigaon, Goalpara
Bihar	Patna, Gaya, Bhagalpur, Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga, Munger, Purnia, Sasaram, Begusarai, Bettiah
Chhattisgarh	Raipur, Bilaspur, Durg, Korba, Raigarh, Jagdalpur, Dhamtari, Rajnandgaon, Ambikapur, Kawardha
Goa	Panaji, Vasco da Gama, Margao, Mapusa, Ponda, Cortalim, Quepem, Canacona, Bicholim, Sanquelim
Gujarat	Ahmedabad, Surat, Vadodara, Rajkot, Gandhinagar, Bhavnagar, Jamnagar, Junagadh, Anand, Nadiad
Haryana	Chandigarh, Faridabad, Gurugram, Ambala, Hisar, Karnal, Panipat, Sonipat, Yamunanagar, Rohtak
Himachal Pradesh	Shimla, Dharamshala, Kullu, Manali, Solan, Mandi, Kangra, Hamirpur, Una, Bilaspur
Jharkhand	Ranchi, Jamshedpur, Dhanbad, Bokaro Steel City, Deoghar, Hazaribagh,

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	Giridih, Dumka, Jamtara, Ramgarh
Karnataka	Bengaluru, Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad, Mangaluru, Belagavi, Ballari, Tumakuru, Shivamogga, Chikkamagaluru, Bidar
Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram, Kochi, Kozhikode, Thrissur, Malappuram, Kollam, Kannur, Palakkad, Alappuzha, Pathanamthitta
Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal, Indore, Gwalior, Jabalpur, Ujjain, Khandwa, Sagar, Satna, Rewa, Dewas
Maharashtra	Mumbai, Pune, Nagpur, Nashik, Thane, Kalyan-Dombivli, Vasai-Virar, Aurangabad, Navi Mumbai, Solapur
Manipur	Imphal, Thoubal, Bishnupur, Churachandpur, Khangabok, Moirang, Kakching, Jiribam, Nambol, Keishamthong
Meghalaya	Shillong, Tura, Jowai, Nongpoh, Williamnagar, Resubelpara, Mawkyrwat, Nongstoin, Baghmara, Ampati
Mizoram	Aizawl, Lunglei, Champhai, Serchhip, Kolasib, Lawngtlai, Mamit, Khawzawl, Saitual, Hnahthial
Nagaland	Kohima, Dimapur, Mokokchung, Wokha, Tuensang, Mon, Zunheboto, Peren, Longleng, Kiphire
Odisha	Bhubaneswar, Cuttack, Rourkela, Berhampur, Sambalpur, Balasore, Bhadrak, Jeypore, Baripada, Angul
Punjab	Amritsar, Ludhiana, Jalandhar, Patiala, Bathinda, Mohali, Hoshiarpur, Moga, Pathankot, Firozpur
Rajasthan	Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota, Udaipur, Ajmer, Bikaner, Alwar, Bhilwara, Sikar, Pali
Sikkim	Gangtok, Namchi, Mangan, Gyalshing, Jorethang, Ravangla, Singtam, Rhenock, Dikchu, Tadong
Tamil Nadu	Chennai, Coimbatore, Madurai, Trichy, Tiruppur, Salem, Tirunelveli, Erode, Vellore, Dindigul
Telangana	Hyderabad, Warangal, Khammam, Karimnagar, Nizamabad, Mahabubnagar, Adilabad, Nalgonda, Medak, Siddipet
Tripura	Agartala, Udaipur, Dharmanagar, Kailashahar, Belonia, Bishalgarh, Sabroom, Amarpur, Jirania, Melaghar
Uttarakhand	Dehradun, Haridwar, Nainital, Roorkee, Haldwani, Rudrapur, Kashipur, Almora, Pauri, Rishikesh
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow, Kanpur, Agra, Varanasi, Allahabad, Meerut, Bareilly, Ghaziabad, Aligarh, Moradabad
West Bengal	Kolkata, Howrah, Siliguri, Durgapur, Asansol, Kalyani, Haldia, Berhampur, Malda, Jalpaiguri
Andaman & Nicobar Islands	Port Blair
Chandigarh	Chandigarh
Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu	Daman, Diu

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Delhi	New Delhi, Dwarka, Rohini, Janakpuri, Pitampura, Karol Bagh, Saket, Lajpat Nagar, Greater Kailash, Vasant Vihar
Puducherry	Puducherry, Karaikal, Mahe, Yanam
Ladakh	Leh, Kargil
Lakshadweep	Kavaratti
Jammu & Kashmir	Jammu, Srinagar, Anantnag, Baramulla, Udhampur, Kathua, Rajouri, Poonch, Samba, Kishtwar

1.5 Testing Format

The Olympiad will be conducted in three phases

Phase 1 (School Level) [Online/Offline Screening Test]

For students via Onboarded Schools: A national-level multiple-choice exam testing knowledge in aviation, STEM, and reasoning. **Top 3 rank**-holders from **Middle School group** from each school will be eligible for participation in Phase 2. **Top 3 rank**-holders from **Higher School group** from each school will be eligible for participation in Phase 2. The exam will be conducted at the school itself. Phase 1 will be conducted starting 19 August 2026. The dates of examination will be different for different zones.

For students via Individual Registration: Students appearing through individual registration shall qualify for Phase 2 if they score equal to or higher than the national average of all 3rd-rankers (Middle School / Higher School) from onboarded schools in the same category, subject to a minimum qualifying score of 50%. The national average benchmark will be computed only after all zonal Phase 1 examinations conclude, ensuring uniformity in evaluation. *Individual students will be ranked within their State/UT as per the residential address on Aadhar/passport.*

Phase 2 (State/UT Rounds) [Online Mode]

This phase will include multiple-choice exam testing knowledge in aviation, STEM, and reasoning. **Top 2 rank**-holders from **Middle School** (Grades 8th-10th) group from **each state** and entire **UT Zone** will be eligible for participation in Phase 3. **Top 3 rank**-holders from **Higher School** group from **each state** and entire **UT Zone** will be **eligible** for participation in **Phase 3**. The exam will be conducted at the individual's school or in online mode at his/her own device itself. Phase 2 will be conducted during the third week of October 2026. *Students via onboarded schools or via individual registration are treated equally in this phase.*

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Phase 3 (National Finale) [Physical Mode]

The final round will include practical quizzes and interview sessions by expert committee members to decide the **TOP 3 Winners** of the National Aviation Olympiad. This phase will be conducted at New Delhi. The national finale is to be conducted on **07 December 2026** on the occasion of **International Aviation Day**.

Note: The exam starts on National Aviation Day and ends on International Aviation Day!

1.6 Infrastructure Requirements

The school shall have the required infrastructure to conduct the exam, i.e., computer lab and **stable internet connection**. If the number of students exceeds the number of computers available, the examination is to be conducted in phases. For schools not having the required infrastructure to conduct the examination, they can **opt for offline conduction** of the examination via OMR sheet. The student can also use their own laptop/computer/tablet device for the remote testing

1.7 Mock Tests

The NAO committee offers mock tests to all the onboarded schools. This shall help the students get a basic idea of the final test and prepare them well. Following are the points to be kept in mind:

1. **Aviation is a new subject domain:** For most students, the exposure of aviation is quite limited at the school level. Mock tests help them in increasing awareness about the same.
2. **Identifying knowledge gaps:** It helps the students to understand where they are lacking. They get a comprehensive analysis of the test they have taken.
3. **Inclusivity:** Students from smaller towns/villages that often get less exposure in aviation will get a chance to practice and not feel disadvantaged.

The mock tests are on-demand basis by the onboarded schools and can be taken any number of times. It is completely **free of charge**. The mock test is **online**.

1.8 Aviation Seminars and Workshops

As a part of the outreach program, NAO committee offers aviation seminars/workshops with the following benefits:

1. Comprehensive **2-hour seminar** for 8th-12th regarding history of aviation, types of aircrafts, aircraft incidents, career opportunities in aviation and drones, regulatory authorities and other aspects of Olympiad syllabus.
2. **Flying session** with RC-aircrafts and drones for students.

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3. Intensive **Q&A sessions** with students and teachers covering doubt clearance regarding the syllabus and format of the Olympiad.

The seminar/workshop is available at a cost of **Rs. 2500 per session** at any location in India for the onboarded school. Logistics costs shall be borne by the school.

1.9 Tentative Benefits / Awards for Students

Category	Benefit / Material	Description / Details	Applicable Level
Participation	Certificate of Participation (Digital)	E-certificate for all registered participants. Lifetime access to NAO newsletters and **20% discount** in next editions.	All Participants
Academic Recognition	Certificate of Achievement (Physical)	Awarded to top 3 (Middle) and top 3 (Higher) students from each school. Signed by **100+ expert committee members.**	Phase 1 – School Level
Academic Recognition	Certificate of Achievement (Physical)	Awarded to all students registered via individual registration qualifying for Phase 2.	Phase 1 – School Level
Academic Recognition	Medals	Awarded to top 3 (Middle) and top 3 (Higher) students from each school. Category: Gold, Silver and Bronze.	Phase 1 – School Level
****Performance Recognition**	Certificate of Distinction + Medal + Cash Prize	Top 5 winners from each State/UT Zone; includes up to ₹10,000 prize and media coverage.	Phase 2 – State/UT Round
****Internship Opportunity**	2 months Internship + Certificate of Internship	Top 5 winners from each State/UT Zone; Internship Coupon (valid till end of Grade 12th). Opportunities in aviation firms, airports, and aerospace institutions in India & abroad.	Phase 2- State/UT Round
National Honour	Certificate of Excellence in Aviation + Trophy + Cash Prize	Top 5 National winners from each grade; prize up to ₹1,00,000 and national-level felicitation.	National Finale
Drone Pilot License	Remote Pilot License	Fully paid drone pilot license training by DGCA-approved RPTO to all 145 finalists of National Finale	State/National Finalists
****Career Mentorship**	Expert Counselling & Career Guidance	One-on-one and group sessions with aviation experts and committee members (valid for 5 years).	State/National Winners

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Networking Opportunities	Expert & Industry Interaction	Interaction with global aviation leaders, institutions, and policymakers during finale.	National Finale
****Scholarships**	Merit & Need-Based Scholarships	**Free College Education for Top 5 winners for aviation education programs through NAO partners.**	National Level
****Exposure Trips**	Industry/Institution Visits	Visits or virtual tours of airports, ATC towers, and aerospace manufacturing units.	State/National Finalists
Aviation Learning Kits	Aeromodelling Kits	RC-Modelling aircrafts; aerodynamics kits.	State/National Finalists
Media Visibility	Press and Digital Recognition	Features in aviation magazines, digital platforms, and official NAO channels.	State/National Winners
Skill Development	Analytical & STEM Skills	Enhances conceptual, reasoning, and application skills through multi-level testing.	All Phases
Community Engagement	Access to NAO Learning Network	Membership in the national aviation student community with continuous learning resources.	All Participants

****Note: This section is a dynamic one and will be finalized by the end of July 2026. Benefits, internships, scholarships, and industry collaborations are subject to partner availability and may change.**

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